

Word family: **portable / portability / portably**

Base word: portable

Related forms: portability, portably

Part of speech: adjective (形容詞) / occasionally noun (少量名詞用法)

Your sentence:

> “In a way, the jacket feels like a **portable memory**.”

Meaning in this passage

Here, **portable** is figurative. It means **something you can carry around with you wherever you go**.

The jacket is being described as if it were a memory made physical: by wearing or carrying the jacket, the speaker also carries the feelings and memories of the Seoul trip.

繁體中文：** **可以隨身攜帶的；能跟着自己到不同地方的**

中文翻譯：

> “The jacket feels like a **portable memory**.”

「這件外套就像一段可以**隨身帶着走的回憶**。」

Here:

portable memory = 彷彿能隨身攜帶、透過實物保存並帶着走的回憶

This is metaphorical, but it still uses the ordinary physical idea of **portable = easy/possible to carry from place to place**.

1. **portable = easy to carry or move (物件) — 便攜的；可攜帶的**

This is the core meaning behind your passage.

Meaning: Small, light, or conveniently designed so that it can be carried or moved from one place to another.

Practice 1

> “I bought a **portable** charger for travelling.”

「我買了一個旅行用的**便攜式**充電器。」

Practice 2

> “The speaker is small and completely **portable**.”

「這個揚聲器很小，而且完全**方便攜帶**。」

Practice 3 — Passage idea

> “The jacket feels like a **portable** memory.”

「這件外套就像一段可以**隨身攜帶**的回憶。」

portable = 可以方便地從一個地方帶到另一個地方

Common:

- * portable charger
- * portable speaker
- * portable computer
- * portable heater
- * portable battery
- * portable device

2. **portable** = movable rather than permanently fixed (設備 / 設施) — 可移動的；非固定式的

Portable can describe equipment or facilities that are designed to be relocated rather than permanently installed.

Practice 4

> “They installed a **portable** air-conditioning unit.”

「他們安裝了一部**可移動式**冷氣機。」

Practice 5

> “The workers used **portable** lighting.”

「工人使用**流動式 / 便攜式**照明設備。」

portable = 並非永久固定在一個位置，可以搬動或重新設置的

This is closely related to Meaning 1, but sometimes the object is not particularly small—it is simply **movable**.

For strict counting, I would keep this under the same physical-portability branch.

3. **portable** = usable across different computers/systems (科技) — 可移植的 ; 跨平台的

In computing, **portable** can mean software, code, data, or a format that can be moved to and used on different systems with little or no modification.

Practice 6

> “The program was designed to be **portable** across different operating systems.”

「這個程式被設計成可在不同作業系統之間**移植 / 跨平台使用**。」

Practice 7

> “The code is highly **portable**.”

「這段程式碼具有很高的**可移植性**。」

portable = 能從一個電腦環境、平台或系統移到另一個並繼續正常使用的

Common:

- * portable code
- * portable software
- * portable application
- * portable format

This is an important technical extension of the broader idea:

> **move it somewhere else and it still works**

4. **portable** = transferable from one job/system/provider to another (權益 / 制度) — 可轉移的 ; 可帶走的

Portable can also describe benefits, insurance, pensions, qualifications, rights, etc. that continue to apply when someone changes jobs, organizations, providers, or locations.

Practice 8

> “The pension benefits are **portable**.”

「這些退休金福利是**可以轉移 / 隨工作轉換帶走的**。」

Practice 9

> “Workers wanted health benefits that were **portable** between jobs.”

「勞工希望醫療福利能在轉工時**繼續保留 / 轉移**。」

portable = 不會因轉換僱主、制度或地點而失效，可以隨人轉移的

This is an established institutional/economic use.

Conceptually, it is very close to the computing sense:

> **something can be transferred elsewhere while retaining its usefulness or validity**

So I would display it separately but merge it at the highest semantic level.

5. **portable** = easily transferred to a new context (抽象) — 可移用的；可套用到別處的

The idea can extend more generally to knowledge, methods, skills, or solutions.

Practice 10

> “These skills are highly **portable** between industries.”

「這些技能在不同行業之間具有很高的**可轉移性**。」

Practice 11

> “The method is simple and **portable** across different settings.”

「這種方法很簡單，而且可以**移用到不同情境**。」

portable = 不局限於原本的環境，可以帶到另一個情境繼續使用

This is a useful abstract extension, especially in professional or academic language.

6. **portable** = noun: portable device/appliance (名詞 , 較少見) — 便攜式設備

Portable can occasionally function as a noun, especially in older or context-specific usage, referring to a portable radio, television, computer, etc.

Practice 12

> “He carried a small **portable** with him.”

「他隨身帶着一部小型**便攜式設備**。」

This noun use is legitimate but much less common today because English normally names the object directly:

- * portable radio
- * portable computer
- * portable TV

So I would mark it as **lower priority**.

Related form: **portability**

Portability means the quality of being portable.

It has several major applications.

physical portability — 便攜性

Practice 13

> “The laptop’s main advantage is its **portability**.”

「這部手提電腦最大的優點是它的**便攜性**。」

software portability — 可移植性

Practice 14

> “The developers improved the software’s **portability**.”

「開發人員改善了軟件的**可移植性**。」

benefit/skill portability — 可轉移性

Practice 15

> “The scheme improves the **portability** of employee benefits.”

「這項制度提升了僱員福利的**可轉移性**。」

portability = 能被攜帶、移動或轉移到另一個地方 / 系統而仍然有用的程度

Related form: **portably**

Portably means in a portable or transferable way.

It exists, but it is relatively uncommon.

Practice 16

> “The application was designed to run **portably** across systems.”

「這個應用程式被設計成能以**跨平台方式**運行。」

For learner priority:

* **portable** → core

* **portability** → useful

* **portably** → lower priority

Useful compound: **portable charger — 行動充電器 / 便攜式充電器**

This belongs directly to Meaning 1.

Useful compound: **portable toilet — 流動廁所**

A **portable toilet** is a self-contained toilet unit that can be moved and temporarily installed at different locations.

This illustrates an important nuance:

****portable does not always mean “small enough to carry in your hand.”****

It can simply mean:

> ****designed to be moved from place to place rather than permanently installed****

Useful compound: ****portable computer — 可攜式電腦****

Historically this term included laptops and other computers designed to be transported.

Again, it belongs under physical portability.

Useful technical term: ****Portable Document Format****

****PDF**** stands for ****Portable Document Format****.

Here, ****portable**** reflects the idea that the document format is intended to preserve and transfer its presentation across different computer environments.

This belongs to the technological transferability branch, not a new meaning.

Important distinction: ****portable vs mobile****

****portable****

means:

> can be moved/carried from place to place

****mobile****

can mean:

> capable of moving, or designed to function while moving

Compare:

> portable speaker

> mobile phone

A portable device may simply be carried somewhere and then used there.

A mobile device often emphasizes use while moving or wireless mobility.

Important distinction: **portable vs movable**

movable

simply means capable of being moved.

portable

usually suggests it is practical or specifically designed to be transported.

A huge table may technically be movable, but you probably would not call it portable.

Important distinction: **portable vs lightweight**

lightweight

means not heavy.

portable

means convenient or possible to transport.

Something can be:

- * lightweight but awkward to carry;

- * portable even though not extremely light.

So the concepts overlap but are not identical.

Important distinction: **portable vs compact**

compact

means small and efficiently arranged.

portable

means easy to transport.

A compact design often improves portability, but one does not automatically imply the other.

Important distinction: **portable vs transferable**

For abstract uses:

transferable

means capable of being transferred from one person/place/system to another.

portable

often adds the metaphor of something **travelling with you** while remaining useful.

> transferable skills

> portable benefits

Very similar, but typical collocations differ.

Important distinction: **portable vs cross-platform**

In technology:

cross-platform

specifically means designed to work on multiple computing platforms.

portable

means capable of being moved/adapted between systems, often with little change.

A program may be portable even if it is not packaged as a fully cross-platform application.

Important distinction: **portable vs wearable**

wearable

means designed to be worn on the body.

portable

means designed to be carried/moved.

A smartwatch is both.

A portable speaker is portable but not wearable.

Grammar note: **portable is normally attributive or predicative**

Before a noun

> a portable speaker

After a linking verb

> "The device is portable."

Both are completely natural.

Countability note

Portable is primarily an adjective, so countability normally does not apply.

As the occasional noun:

> a portable

> several portables

is possible, but much less central in contemporary everyday English.

Portability is generally uncountable:

> portability of the device

> software portability

Family-extension note

The practical modern family is compact:

* **portable**
* **portability**
* **portably**

The semantic network is unusually coherent. The underlying concept is:

> **something can move from one place, environment, or system to another without losing its usefulness**

This produces:

* physical portability
* technical/software portability
* benefit/pension portability
* skill/method portability

The last three should be surfaced because the domains are important, but they should not be inflated into unrelated core meanings when the same transferability concept still works.

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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portable — physical object	可以方便攜帶或搬到另一個地方使用的
portable — movable equipment	並非永久固定，可以搬動、重新設置的
portable — computing	能移到不同電腦平台 / 系統而仍能使用的；可移植的
portable — benefits/rights	在轉換工作、制度或機構後仍可保留 / 轉移的
portable — skills/methods	可以從一個環境或領域移用到另一個的
a portable — noun	便攜式設備；較低頻
portability	便攜性；可移植性；可轉移性
portably	以可移植 / 可轉移的方式；較低頻

For your original sentence

> “In a way, the jacket feels like a **portable memory**.”

The exact meaning is:

portable = 可以跟着自己一起帶到不同地方的

So:

> **a portable memory**

= **一段彷彿可以隨身帶着走的回憶**

The expression is deliberately metaphorical: a memory is not physically portable in the ordinary sense, but the **jacket acts as a physical carrier of the memory**.

For your database, I would count **2 genuinely useful core meanings** for **portable**:

1. **physically easy/designed to be carried or moved**
2. **transferable/usable in another system, institution, job, or context**

I would merge software, benefit, qualification, and skill portability under #2, while keeping their domain-specific examples explicit for learner clarity.